

IPL Data Analysis — Plain-English Summary

Q1 — Toss Impact:

Toss winners won 50.4% of matches — essentially the same as a coin flip. Winning the toss gives almost no advantage.

Q2 — Phase That Matters Most:

All three phases show winners scoring more, but the Middle overs (6–14) have the biggest gap: winners average 78.8 runs vs losers' 71.0 — a difference of 7.8 runs. The Powerplay gap is 6.6 runs and Death overs just 3.8. Controlling the middle overs is most strongly linked to winning.

Q3 — Top 5 Batters (by runs):

1. Shubman Gill — 2,927 runs
2. Virat Kohli — 2,783 runs
3. KL Rahul — 2,582 runs
4. Faf du Plessis — 2,471 runs
5. Jos Buttler — 2,406 runs

Top 5 Bowlers (by wickets):

1. Harshal Patel — 105 wickets
2. Yuzvendra Chahal — 100 wickets
3. Arshdeep Singh — 85 wickets
4. Rashid Khan — 83 wickets
5. Avesh Khan — 83 wickets

Surprise Finding:

Winning the toss gives almost zero advantage — toss winners win just 50.4% of matches, barely better than a coin flip. Yet the Middle overs show the largest gap between winners and losers (+7.8 runs), meaning what happens long after the toss is far more decisive than the toss itself.